



Smart Kitchen

User Manual

AI-Powered Meal Planning for Your Family

For Families, Caregivers & Seniors • Version 2.0

FOREWORD

How Smart Kitchen Came to Be

This app started with a question I dreaded hearing.

My wife has been dealing with a health condition that keeps her from doing much of the cooking. I took that over without a second thought — it's what you do. But after a full day of work, making decisions all day, managing everything that comes with that, I'd walk through the door already running on empty.

And then she'd ask: *"What's for dinner?"*

I'd get irritated. Not at her — never at her. Just at the question itself. That one more decision at the end of a day when I had nothing left to give. I didn't want to feel that way. I knew it wasn't fair. But I couldn't seem to stop it.

Around the same time I was exploring how AI could fit into real daily life — not as a novelty, not as a tech experiment, but as something genuinely useful. I kept asking myself: what are the friction points in my day that I could actually hand off?

That question was one of them.

■ The Idea

What if the app just knew what was for dinner?

What if it looked at what was already in the kitchen, knew who it was cooking for, knew which nights were crazy and which ones had time to spare — and just handled it?

Not a recipe website. Not a search engine. A system that thinks ahead so the person doing the cooking doesn't have to.

That's Smart Kitchen. Built by a husband who does the cooking, for anyone who's ever stood in front of the refrigerator at 6 PM too tired to think. The app doesn't replace the cook — it just takes the decision off their plate.

Along the way it grew into something bigger: a tool that can manage dietary restrictions for someone managing a chronic condition, help a senior living alone eat well without the mental overhead, and give a family of seven a plan for the week in about fifteen seconds.

But it started with one exhausted question and the decision to do something about it.

— *Rick Rinehart*

Creator, Smart Kitchen

SECTION 1

Welcome to Smart Kitchen

Smart Kitchen is your family's AI-powered kitchen assistant. It helps you figure out what to cook, keeps track of what's in your refrigerator, freezer, and pantry, builds a full week of meal plans tailored to your family's needs, and generates your grocery list — all in one place.

You don't need to download anything from the App Store. Smart Kitchen runs right in your phone's browser. Just open it and you're ready to go.

Who It's For

Smart Kitchen is designed for anyone who feeds a family — whether that's a busy parent managing multiple kids' schedules, a caregiver managing a loved one's medical diet, or a senior who wants simple, healthy meal ideas without the overwhelm.

The Household Manager Model

Smart Kitchen is built around one primary user per household — the person who manages meals and grocery shopping. That person sets up the app, manages inventory, and generates meal plans.

- One person manages the kitchen profile, inventory, and meal plan
- Family members can view the meal plan and shopping list
- Each household has its own profile with its own dietary needs and preferences

What You'll Need to Get Started

- A smartphone, tablet, or computer with internet access

- A web browser — Chrome or Safari work great
- A few minutes to walk through the Setup Wizard
- Grocery receipts (optional but helpful)

■ Add It to Your Home Screen

Adding Smart Kitchen to your phone's home screen makes it feel just like a regular app — one tap to open.

On iPhone: tap the Share button in Safari → 'Add to Home Screen.'

On Android: tap the three-dot menu in Chrome → 'Add to Home Screen.'

Senior Mode

Smart Kitchen includes a **Senior Mode** designed for users who prefer larger text, simplified navigation, and a cleaner, less cluttered interface. Senior Mode is fully operational and can be turned on at any time.

1 Tap the Settings icon from the main menu

Look for the gear icon in the top corner of the home screen.

2 Tap 'Senior Mode'

A toggle switch appears. Tap it to turn Senior Mode on.

3 The interface updates immediately

Text grows larger, buttons become easier to tap, and the navigation simplifies. No restart needed.

4 Toggle it off the same way

Senior Mode can be turned on or off at any time from Settings.

■ Designed for Comfort

Senior Mode was built with the SMG Senior Resource audience in mind.

It doesn't remove any features — it just makes everything easier to see and tap.

Great for anyone who finds the standard interface a little small or busy.

SECTION 2

Getting Started — Setup Wizard

The first time you open Smart Kitchen, a friendly Setup Wizard walks you through everything. It sets up your family's profile, dietary needs, preferences, and starting inventory so the app is ready to cook for your household from day one. The whole thing takes about five minutes.

Welcome Screen & Setup Preview

The welcome screen greets you with the Smart Kitchen logo and a brief overview of what the app does. Before the wizard begins, a **Setup Preview screen** shows you the steps ahead — so you know what to expect and nothing comes as a surprise.

- The preview lists each wizard step in order
- Tap **Get Started** to begin
- Tap **Skip Setup** to go straight to the app — you can always run the wizard later from Settings

Step 1 — Family Profile & Dietary Needs

The wizard starts with your Family Profile — the most important setup step. Everything about who the app is cooking for lives here: your household details, dietary preferences, medical restrictions, and any temporary diet needs. Set it once and Smart Kitchen applies it to every recipe and meal plan automatically.

Your Household

1**Enter your household name**

Something simple like 'Our Family' or 'The Rineharts.'

2 Set the number of people and general age ranges

This helps the app scale portions correctly — toddlers, teens, and adults all eat differently.

3 Select proteins your family eats

Chicken, Beef, Pork, Fish, Seafood, Turkey, Lamb, Vegetarian, and more. Tap each one that applies.

4 Tap Next to continue to dietary needs

You're not done with Step 1 yet — dietary restrictions are part of the same setup.

Dietary Restrictions — Permanent

Permanent dietary restrictions apply every time Smart Kitchen generates a recipe or meal plan. Set these for any ongoing household need — food allergies, lifestyle choices, or long-term health requirements.

- Check off everything that applies: Gluten-Free, Dairy-Free, Nut Allergy, Vegetarian, Vegan, Low Carb, and more
- Smart Kitchen enforces these at the AI level — it substitutes ingredients automatically, not just flags them
- Brown rice instead of white rice. Whole wheat pasta instead of regular. Reduced sodium throughout.
- You don't have to remind the app every time — it remembers and applies these permanently

Medical Dietary Needs — Permanent

If someone in your household has a medically-managed diet, set it here alongside your general restrictions. These are enforced the same way — at the AI prompt level, with automatic ingredient substitutions throughout every meal plan.

Diabetic-Friendly

Lower glycemic ingredients, reduced sugars, whole grains throughout.

Heart-Healthy	Low sodium, low saturated fat, heart-supportive ingredient choices.
Low Sodium	Reduced salt across all recipes and meal plans.
Renal Diet	Restricted potassium, phosphorus, and sodium for kidney health.
Anti-Inflammatory	Emphasizes whole foods, healthy fats, and anti-inflammatory ingredients.

■ Medical Dietary Profiles — How They Work

Smart Kitchen doesn't just flag non-compliant ingredients — it replaces them. A diabetic profile means every meal plan uses brown rice instead of white, whole wheat pasta instead of regular, and lower-glycemic choices throughout. You set it once here and the app handles it automatically from that point forward. Always follow your healthcare provider's specific dietary guidance. When your doctor or dietitian updates your parameters, update your profile here and your meal plans will stay in sync automatically.

Temporary Medical Diets

Some dietary needs are short-term — surgery prep, post-op recovery, a medication-related restriction, or a time-limited health program. Temporary profiles layer on top of your permanent profile and deactivate automatically when the time period ends.

Surgery Prep	Low-fiber, clear liquid, or reduced-residue diets before a procedure.
Post-Op Recovery	Soft foods, low-residue, or easily digestible meals during healing.
Medication Diet	Avoid specific foods that interact with medications — grapefruit, high-potassium items, etc.
Elimination Diet	Temporarily remove specific ingredients to identify food sensitivities.

Short-Term Program

A 30-day low-carb challenge, cardiac rehab diet, or dietitian-prescribed plan.

1 Tap 'Add Temporary Diet' in Step 1

This opens the temporary diet options alongside your permanent profile.

2 Select the diet type or build a custom one

Check off the relevant restrictions.

3 Set the duration

3 days, 1 week, 2 weeks, or a custom end date.

4 Tap Save

The temporary diet is active immediately and layers on top of your permanent profile.

5 It deactivates automatically when the time is up

Your permanent profile continues as normal. You can also turn it off early at any time from Settings.

■ Everything About Who You're Cooking For — In One Place

Household details, dietary preferences, permanent medical restrictions, and temporary diets are all set in Step 1.

You won't be asked for this information again. The app remembers it and applies it automatically to every recipe, meal plan, and suggestion going forward.

Step 2 — How to Add Inventory

Smart Kitchen asks how you'd like to build your starting kitchen inventory. This step is new — it gives you a clear choice before diving into the pantry checklist.

1 Scan a Receipt

Point your camera at a recent grocery receipt. The app reads every food item and adds them to your inventory automatically. Fastest option if you just came back from the store.

2 Scan Shelf Items

Walk through your kitchen and scan items directly — fridge, freezer, pantry shelves. Labels need to be clearly visible for best results.

3 I'll Add Items Manually

Skip scanning for now. You can type items in by hand and add them one at a time. Good if you're just getting started and want to move quickly.

4 Set Up Later

Skip inventory setup entirely and go straight to the app. You can add inventory anytime from the main menu.

Step 3 — Proteins

Smart Kitchen asks which proteins your family eats. This helps it build meal plans and recipe suggestions that match your household — not just a generic list.

- Tap each protein your family eats: Chicken, Beef, Pork, Fish, Seafood, Turkey, Lamb, Vegetarian, and more
- Tap again to deselect anything you accidentally tapped
- You can update your protein list anytime from your Family Profile settings

Step 4 — Recipe Site Preference

Choose the recipe websites you trust most. Smart Kitchen uses these as inspiration when generating suggestions.

Family-friendly, crowd-pleasing meals AllRecipes

Restaurant-quality recipes with detailed instructions Food Network

Quick, visual recipes that are easy to follow Tasty

Straightforward home cooking, minimal fuss Simply Recipes

Let Smart Kitchen decide based on your family's needs No Preference

Step 5 — Pantry Setup Choice

Smart Kitchen asks how you want to handle your pantry staples — the everyday items like oil, salt, flour, and canned goods that most kitchens always have.

1 Scan My Pantry Now

The app opens the camera so you can scan shelf items right away. Labels facing forward, counter method works best.

2 Use the Pantry Checklist

Skip scanning and use a curated checklist of common staples instead — faster if your pantry is well-stocked.

3 Skip for Now

Move on without setting up pantry inventory. You can always add items later.

Step 6 — Pantry Checklist

If you chose the checklist route, Smart Kitchen shows you a list of the most common pantry staples — olive oil, salt, pepper, flour, canned tomatoes, pasta, and more. Check off what you already have.

- Items you check go straight into your inventory
- This gives the app a solid starting point for recipes even before your first receipt scan

■ Shopping List Confirmation

After the pantry checklist, Smart Kitchen asks if you'd like to add any missing common staples to your shopping list.

Tap Yes to generate a starter list, or Skip to continue without one.

Once the wizard is complete, you land on the Smart Kitchen home screen — fully set up and ready to cook.

SECTION 3

Managing Your Inventory

Your inventory is the heart of Smart Kitchen. The more accurate it is, the better your recipe suggestions and meal plans will be. There are four ways to add items — pick whichever fits the moment.

Scanning Grocery Receipts

The fastest way to add a lot of items at once after a grocery run. Point your camera at the receipt and the app reads every food item automatically.

- 1 Tap 'Scan Receipt' from the home screen or inventory menu**
This opens your camera in receipt scanning mode.
- 2 Lay the receipt flat on a counter in good light**
Shadows and crumples make it harder to read. Natural light works best.
- 3 Center the receipt and tap Capture**
For long receipts, take two photos — top half first, then bottom half.
- 4 Review the items the app found**
A list appears showing all detected food items. Remove anything misread.
- 5 Confirm expiry dates if shown**
When the app can read a date from the label, it displays it. For items without a printed date, Smart Kitchen shows an estimated shelf life based on the product type.
- 6 Tap 'Add to Inventory'**
All confirmed items are saved. Your inventory is updated.

■ Expiry Date Hints

Smart Kitchen reads expiry dates two ways:

- Firm dates — when a 'Best By' or 'Use By' date is clearly printed and readable on the label.
- Estimated hints — when no date is readable, the app estimates shelf life based on the product

category (e.g., canned goods: 2 years, fresh chicken: 2-3 days, hard cheese: 3-4 weeks).

Expiry hints are a guide — always use your own judgment with perishables.

Scanning Shelf & Package Items

For items already in your kitchen, scan them directly from the fridge, freezer, or pantry. The key is making sure labels are clearly visible.

■ Best Results — The Counter Method

Instead of photographing a full shelf, take items out and line them up on a clear counter with labels facing forward — like a little grocery store shelf.

This gives the camera a clean view and produces the most accurate results.

Frozen items are fine out of the freezer for the 2-3 minutes it takes to scan.

1 Pull items from the fridge, freezer, or pantry

Do one area at a time — fridge first, then freezer, then pantry.

2 Stand items up with labels facing forward on a clear counter

Group similar items together. Make sure brand names and item names are visible.

3 Tap 'Scan Items' and hold the camera steady

Frame 4-6 items at a time for best accuracy.

4 Review detected items and expiry dates

Firm dates show as-is. Estimated hints are labeled '~est.' so you know the difference.

5 Tap 'Add to Inventory'

Confirmed items are saved. Put everything back.

Tips by Location

- Refrigerator — Pull items to the front of shelves so labels face out. Condiments in the door are usually easy — they stand upright with labels forward already.
- Freezer — Boxes and bags scan very well. Smooth out crumpled bags before scanning.
- Pantry — Cans, boxes, and jars are the easiest. Group by type: all cans together, all boxes together.
- Produce & Bulk Items — Fresh produce and bulk bin items don't have scannable labels. Add those manually.

Manual Add with Category Pills

For items the scanner can't read — fresh produce, butcher meat, leftovers, bulk items — type them in manually in just a few seconds.

1 Tap 'Add Item' in the inventory screen

A simple text entry field opens.

2 Type what you have

Keep it simple: 'carrots', '1 lb ground beef', 'half bag brown rice.'

3 Select a category pill

Tap the category that fits: Produce, Meat, Dairy, Pantry, Frozen, Baking, Leftovers, etc.

4 Set a location (optional)

Choose Fridge, Freezer, or Pantry so you always know where to find it.

5 Tap Save

The item is added to your inventory immediately.

Baking Category

Smart Kitchen includes a dedicated **Baking** category for ingredients used in baking and desserts. This keeps your baking staples organized separately from everyday pantry items and helps the Desserts feature give you better suggestions.

- Items in the Baking category include: flour, sugar, brown sugar, baking soda, baking powder, vanilla extract, chocolate chips, cocoa powder, yeast, powdered sugar, and more
- When you request a dessert recipe, Smart Kitchen checks your Baking inventory first
- The On Hand / Needed badges in the Desserts section reflect your Baking category stock

Inline Category & Location Editing

You can update an item's category or storage location directly from the inventory card — no need to delete and re-add it.

1 Tap any item in your inventory

The item card expands to show full details.

2 Tap the category pill or location tag on the card

These are tappable — they open a quick edit menu.

3 Select the correct category or location

Changes apply instantly. The card updates right there without leaving the inventory screen.

⇒ ■ Quick Correction

If the scanner puts something in the wrong category — say it reads a bag of flour as 'Pantry' instead of 'Baking' — just tap the category pill on the card and fix it in two seconds. No deleting, no re-scanning needed.

Adjusting Quantities

- Tap any item in your inventory to open the card
- Use the + and – buttons to adjust quantity
- Tap the trash icon to remove an item completely
- Changes save automatically

Wednesday & Sunday Review Reminders

Smart Kitchen sends you a reminder twice a week — Wednesday and Sunday — to do a quick inventory check. This keeps your stock levels accurate and your meal plan suggestions reliable.

- Sunday sets you up for the week ahead — perfect timing before meal planning
- Wednesday catches mid-week changes — things you've cooked, used up, or restocked
- Each check-in takes about two minutes

■ Why Twice a Week?

Two quick check-ins per week keeps your inventory accurate enough to trust.

The reminders appear as a notification on your device.

Tap the reminder to open Smart Kitchen directly to the inventory review screen.

SECTION 4

Meal Planning

The meal planner generates a full 7-day dinner plan for your family in about 10-15 seconds — tailored to your dietary needs, your inventory, and the pace of your week.

Generating Your 7-Day Plan

- 1 Tap 'Meal Plan' from the home screen**
This opens the meal planning screen.
- 2 Select your family profile**
Your dietary restrictions and preferences load automatically.
- 3 Add any special notes (optional)**
Example: 'include one pasta night' or 'nothing with shellfish this week.'
- 4 Tap 'Generate Meal Plan'**
The AI builds your full 7-day dinner plan in about 10-15 seconds.
- 5 Review your plan**
Seven meal cards appear — one for each day of the week.

Reading the Meal Plan Card

- The day of the week and meal name
- A one-line description of the dish
- Estimated prep and cook time
- A Quick Meal badge for meals under 30 minutes

- A Busy Night flag if you've marked that evening as hectic

TAP FOR FULL RECIPE

Tap any meal plan card to open the full recipe. The recipe view shows the complete ingredient list, step-by-step cooking instructions, and On Hand / Needed badges for every ingredient. Tap any Needed ingredient to add it to your shopping list instantly.

Change Meal

Don't like what the app picked for a particular night? Swap it without regenerating the whole week.

1 Tap 'Change Meal' on any day's card

Two options appear.

2 Surprise Me

The app picks a completely new meal — different protein, different cuisine, same dietary rules.

3 Make a Specific Request

Type what you're in the mood for: 'something with salmon' or 'a slow cooker meal' or 'Italian.' The app generates a new meal based on your request.

Busy Night / Quick Meal Flag

Mark hectic evenings as Busy Nights and Smart Kitchen automatically assigns a quick, easy dinner for that day.

1 Tap the flag icon next to any day

A menu appears.

2**Select 'Busy Night'**

The dinner for that day is replaced with a Quick Meal — under 30 minutes, one pan, or a slow-cooker recipe you can start in the morning.

3**The rest of the week stays the same**

Only the flagged night changes.

■ Built for Active Families

Between practices, games, and activities across multiple kids, some nights dinner just needs to be fast.

Flag those nights and let Smart Kitchen handle the planning.

Made It! — Updating Inventory After Cooking

When you finish cooking a meal from your plan, tap **Made It!** on the meal card. Smart Kitchen automatically removes the ingredients you used from your inventory — no manual updating needed.

SECTION 5

Recipes

The recipe feature gives you meal ideas based on what's already in your kitchen — so you can cook something great tonight without a last-minute grocery run.

How Recipe Suggestions Work

Smart Kitchen's AI looks at your inventory, your family profile, and any preferences you've set, then generates personalized recipe ideas. You can get recipes two ways:

Tap 'Get Recipe Ideas' and the app pulls from what you already have on hand. From Your Inventory

Type a few ingredients — 'chicken thighs, broccoli, garlic' — and the app builds recipes around those. Type What You Have

On Hand vs. Needed Badges

Every ingredient in a recipe is tagged so you know exactly what you have and what you need:

On Hand	You already have this in your inventory. No shopping needed.
Needed	You're out of this. Tap it to add directly to your shopping list.

I Cooked This — Update Inventory

When you cook a recipe from the Recipes section, tap **I Cooked This** when done. Just like the 'Made It!' button in the meal plan, this automatically removes the used ingredients from your inventory.

SECTION 6

Desserts

The Desserts section works exactly like the Recipes section — just focused on sweet treats. Smart Kitchen suggests dessert ideas based on what you have in your pantry and Baking category inventory.

How Dessert Suggestions Work

- Tap 'Desserts' from the home screen or main menu
- The app generates ideas based on your Baking category and pantry inventory
- On Hand and Needed badges appear on every ingredient
- Tap 'I Cooked This' when done to update your inventory automatically

The Baking Category Connection

The Baking category is specifically designed to work with the Desserts feature. When you stock your Baking inventory — flour, sugar, chocolate chips, vanilla, baking soda — the Desserts section knows exactly what you can make tonight without a store run.

■ Quick Tip

Keep your Baking category updated and you'll almost always have the ingredients for a simple dessert on hand.

Try typing 'quick dessert with pantry staples' for easy weeknight ideas like brownies, cookies, or a simple cake with what you already have.

SECTION 7

Shopping List

Smart Kitchen builds your grocery list automatically from your meal plan and recipe needs — no more writing things down or forgetting items at the store.

How It's Generated

When you generate a 7-day plan, the app compares what's needed against your inventory. Anything missing goes on the list. Meal Plan Gaps

Tap any Needed ingredient in a recipe to add it to your list instantly. Recipe Needed Badges

Add anything directly from the Shopping List screen — household items, snacks, whatever you need. Manual Adds

Using the Shopping List at the Store

- 1 Open Smart Kitchen on your phone at the store**
Your shopping list loads automatically.
- 2 Tap each item as you put it in the cart**
The item gets a checkmark.
- 3 Items are grouped by category**
Produce, Meat, Dairy, Pantry, Baking, Frozen — shop each section without backtracking.
- 4 Tap 'Done Shopping' when finished**
The app confirms your list is complete.

■ ■ Print Your List

Prefer paper? Tap the Print button for a clean, formatted shopping list.

The printed list uses the same category groupings for easy store navigation.

SECTION 8 — PREMIUM FEATURE

Weekly Ad Sale Planner

■ Coming Soon — Premium Feature

The Weekly Ad Sale Planner is in active development and will be available as part of the Smart Kitchen Premium subscription when it launches.

Here's a preview of what it will do.

What It Will Do

The Weekly Ad Sale Planner connects your local grocery store's weekly circular to your meal planning. Instead of planning meals and then shopping, you'll plan around what's on sale — saving money and reducing waste at the same time.

Scanning the Weekly Ad

Point your camera at your store's weekly ad flyer — or upload a photo of it. Smart Kitchen reads the sale items and adds them to a temporary 'Sale Items' inventory alongside your regular stock.

Building a Sale Meal Plan

Tap 'Plan Around Sales' and the app generates a meal plan that prioritizes this week's sale items. If chicken is half price, expect to see chicken-based dinners in your plan — with variety built in so it doesn't feel repetitive.

Clearing Sale Items Week to Week

At the end of each week, the app prompts you to clear last week's sale items and scan the new weekly ad — keeping your sale inventory fresh and your meal plans current.

■ Expected Launch

The Weekly Ad Sale Planner is planned for Phase 3 of Smart Kitchen development. Premium subscribers will receive access automatically when it launches.

SECTION 9

Managing Family Profiles

Your family profile — including all household details, dietary restrictions, medical dietary needs, and temporary diets — is set up during the Setup Wizard in Step 1. This section covers how to update or manage your profile after the initial setup.

Editing Your Profile

- 1 Tap the menu icon and select 'Family Profiles'**
This opens your household profile settings.
- 2 Tap 'Edit Profile'**
All the same fields from Step 1 of the wizard are here — household name, people, age ranges, proteins, dietary restrictions, and medical needs.
- 3 Make your changes and tap Save**
Changes apply immediately to your next recipe or meal plan generation.

Adding a Temporary Medical Diet After Setup

You don't have to be in the wizard to add a temporary diet. If a medical situation comes up after you've completed setup — a surgery, a new medication, a dietitian's recommendation — you can add it anytime.

- 1 Go to Family Profiles from the menu**
Opens your profile settings.

2**Tap 'Add Temporary Diet'**

Select from the preset types or build a custom restriction list.

3**Set the duration and tap Activate**

The temporary diet layers on top of your permanent profile immediately.

4**It deactivates automatically when the time period ends**

Or turn it off early at any time from this screen.

■ Medical Note

Smart Kitchen's dietary profiles support household meal planning.

They are not a substitute for medical advice from your doctor or dietitian.

Always follow your healthcare provider's specific guidance.

When your dietitian updates your parameters, update your profile here and your meal plans will stay in sync automatically.

SECTION 10

Frequently Asked Questions

Why don't other family members see my inventory?

Smart Kitchen currently uses one primary user per household. Your inventory, meal plan, and shopping list live in your browser session. Cloud sync across multiple devices — so the whole family can see the same inventory — is planned for Phase 3.

How do I start over?

Go to Settings and tap 'Reset Inventory' to clear your inventory without affecting your profiles or preferences. Tap 'Reset All Data' to start completely fresh from the Setup Wizard.

What if the scanner misreads an item?

After every scan, the app shows you what it detected before adding anything. Review the list and remove anything misread. You can also tap any item in your inventory and use the inline editing to fix the name, category, or location directly on the card.

What's the difference between a firm expiry date and an estimated hint?

A firm date means the app read an actual 'Best By' or 'Use By' date printed on the label. An estimated hint (shown as '~est.') means no date was readable, so the app estimated shelf life based on the product type. Always use your own judgment with perishables — the hints are a guide, not a guarantee.

How do I change my recipe site preference?

Go to Settings → Recipe Preferences. Your new preference takes effect on the next recipe or meal plan you generate.

How do I turn Senior Mode on or off?

Go to Settings from the main menu and tap 'Senior Mode.' Tap the toggle to turn it on or off. The interface updates immediately — no restart needed. Senior Mode makes text larger, buttons easier to tap, and navigation simpler without removing any features.

Does Smart Kitchen work without internet?

No — the AI that powers recipe suggestions and meal planning runs in the cloud, so an internet connection is required. Your inventory is stored locally in your browser, so you can view it offline, but you can't generate new recipes or meal plans without a connection.

Can I use Smart Kitchen on multiple devices?

You can open it on any device with a browser, but your inventory and meal plan are currently tied to the device and browser you used to set up the app. Cloud sync across multiple devices is planned for Phase 3.

What if I don't want to scan anything?

That's fine. You can type ingredients manually, generate meal plans from your family profile alone, and manage your shopping list by hand. Scanning just makes things faster — it's never required.

APPENDIX

Smart Kitchen Roadmap

Smart Kitchen is a living app — new features are added regularly based on family feedback and real-world use.

Phase 1 — Complete ■

■ All Phase 1 Features Are Live

Every feature below is fully operational at smart-kitchen-opal.vercel.app

- AI-powered recipe suggestions from inventory or manual input
- Receipt scanning with expiry date reading (firm dates + estimated hints)
- Fridge, freezer, and pantry item scanning — counter method
- Manual inventory add with category pills and location tagging
- Inline category and location editing on inventory cards
- Baking category with Desserts section integration
- Expiry date tracking — firm dates and estimated shelf-life hints
- 7-day meal plan generation with full dietary compliance
- Family dietary profiles — permanent and temporary medical diets
- Surgery prep, post-op, and medication diet temporary profiles
- Busy Night / Quick Meal flag
- Change Meal — Surprise Me and specific request
- Made It! and I Cooked This inventory auto-updates
- Google Calendar integration
- Shopping list with category grouping and print option

- Wednesday and Sunday inventory review reminders
- Setup Wizard — all 7 steps including new Family Profile first flow
- Welcome screen and setup preview screen
- Senior Mode toggle — larger text, simplified navigation
- Desserts section

Phase 2 — Coming Soon

Phase 2 targets August 2026, timed to the SMG Senior Resource Day demonstration.

- Medication interaction flags — alerts when a meal contains foods that interact with common medications
- Kyle's updated VA dietitian dietary parameters (post-appointment)
- Per-day meal regeneration button
- Enhanced inventory review reminder system
- Additional senior UI refinements based on SMG demo feedback

Phase 3 — Future

- Cloud sync — shared household accounts across multiple devices
- Weekly Ad Sale Planner — Premium feature, build meal plans around grocery store sales
- SmartSaveMeds integration — medication cost and interaction touchpoint
- Budget optimization for shopping lists
- App Store native builds for iOS and Android
- B2B licensing for senior living communities
- Caregiver platform features

■ Your Feedback Shapes What Gets Built

Smart Kitchen gets better because of real-world use by real families.

If something doesn't work the way you expect, or you wish it did something different — say so.

Text Rick directly. Screenshots of anything confusing are always helpful.